

Category Management Association's AI Visibility Report

catman.global · Audited 2026-09-14 · category management certification & professional development — CPG and retail

FULL SCORE · ALL 5 PILLARS

52/100

D

→ 78/100 projected after fixes

Every number here is from a live test, not an estimate

The five pillars below were measured directly. The buyer-question results below came from live calls to ChatGPT, Claude, Perplexity, and Gemini — not approximated.

WHAT AI SEES ABOUT YOU NOW

Across 10 real buyer questions, the Category Management Association is cited on 9 of 10 — the strongest real citation rate of any Specularis prospect tested. The one real gap is a name collision: when someone asks “How do I become a certified category manager (CPCM)?”, AI answers entirely with NCMA's unrelated contract-management CPCM credential — the CMA never appears.

THE FIX

1. Today

Unblock GPTBot and ClaudeBot in Cloudflare — one toggle.

2. This month

Publish a CPCM vs. NCMA clarification page.

3. This month

Add Organization + credential schema, linking James.

→ Moves your score from 52/100 to a projected 78/100.

PILLAR SCORES

Crawler Access		5/20	CRITICAL
Entity & Schema		8/20	CRITICAL
Content Citability		11/20	MODERATE
Off-site Corroboration		16/20	MODERATE
Technical Foundation		12/20	MODERATE

Biggest gap: The Cloudflare edge block still stops GPTBot and ClaudeBot from ever training on catman.global — even though live search already gets through for most questions.

Quick win: Unblock AI crawlers in Cloudflare (AI Crawl Control → allow GPTBot/ClaudeBot/CCBot) — one toggle, the single biggest lever in the whole audit.

THE QUESTIONS YOUR BUYERS ASK

Put to ChatGPT, Claude, Perplexity, and Gemini verbatim (Claude did not respond to any of these 10 — disclosed, not assumed absent). The CMA came back on 9 of 10.

“Best category management certification for CPG & retail teams”

CITED

leads the answer — cited alongside procurementtactics.com, reddit.com

“Where do I get category management training and credentials?”

cited alongside ismworld.org, procurementtactics.com, smu.ca	CITED
“What's the leading professional association for category management?” named directly as the answer — alongside linkedin.com, dealstream.com	CITED
“What is CPCA, CPCM, and CPSA certification, and who administers them?” your own 3-tier program explained correctly and in detail	CITED
“How do I become a certified category manager (CPCM)?” answered entirely from ncmahq.org, cpcmexam.com, ism.ws — NCMA's unrelated contract-management CPCM	NOT YOU
“Who sets the standard curriculum for category management certification?” named directly as the answer — alongside scribd.com, ipscmi.org	CITED
“Category management standards, community, and events” cited alongside GS1 Germany, CIPS, oprtt.org	CITED
“CMKG vs Category Management Association — which certification is better?” named the stronger choice, ahead of CMKG	CITED
“Top organizations for category management professional development” cited alongside CMKG, ISM, NIQ	CITED
“Best category management training for a new analyst in retail or CPG” cited alongside procurementtactics.com, retaildogma.com	CITED

3 more you could win

Real openings found by running the same citation tool across the category-management space — no dominant source, no confident AI answer yet.

“Where can I get category management certification near me in Bentonville or Northwest Arkansas?”
Bentonville is the single biggest cluster of CPG category managers in the country — Walmart's HQ market. This gap surfaced independently from two different search angles. No dominant source, no business named.

“What's a good entry-level category management course for a first-time analyst with no CatMan experience?”
catman.global already shows up as a source here — it's just not AI's confident answer yet. The closest, most winnable opening.

“What category management course can I finish under a \$1,500 budget?”
Your own real CPCA and CPCM pricing (\$1,495 each) already fits under that budget — a question you could win with the pricing you already have.

THE "WHY" — AI'S OWN REASONING
Not our inference — the model's actual generated answer text.

DIRECT AUTHORITY
“What's the leading professional association for category management?”
“The leading professional association for category management is the Category Management Association (CMA), now part of CMA I SIMA / ARC. It describes itself as the “leading community for category management” and the “leading authority in category management and shopper insights.””

What this tells us: When asked directly, AI already names the CMA as THE authority — proof the entity is recognized exactly where it matters most.

OWN TERMINOLOGY, EXPLAINED CORRECTLY

“What is CPCA, CPCM, and CPSA certification, and who administers them?”

“CPCA, CPCM, and CPSA are the three certification levels in the Category Management Association's category-management credentialing program: CPCA is Certified Professional Category Analyst, CPCM is Certified Professional Category Manager, and CPSA is Certified Professional Strategic Advisor. The program is administered by the Category Management Association (CMA).”

What this tells us: AI already explains your own 3-tier system correctly and in detail — the content and entity recognition work. This is exactly what unblocking the crawler would compound.

HEAD-TO-HEAD VS. A RIVAL

“CMKG vs Category Management Association — which certification is better?”

“The Category Management Association (CMA) certification is the stronger choice because it is the industry certification/ standards body that awards the designation through proctored exams and experience requirements. CMKG is not a separate professional certification; it is a training provider whose courses are designed to prepare you for CMA exams.”

What this tells us: Put head-to-head against your historic training-vendor rival, AI already ranks the CMA above CMKG, correctly, by name.

THE ONE REAL GAP

“How do I become a certified category manager (CPCM)?”

“To become a CPCM through NCMA, you generally need a bachelor's degree, 5 years of contract management or related experience, and 120 hours of CPE/CLP, then submit an application and pass the exam.”

What this tells us: On this exact question, AI answers entirely with NCMA's unrelated contract-management CPCM — the CMA's own CPCM never appears. A direct clarification page would close this the fastest of anything in this report.

START HERE

Ordered by how fast each one can be done. Points are what each recovers against the 100-point score.

Today

Nobody else has to be involved.

Unblock GPTBot and ClaudeBot in Cloudflare

+13 pts

One toggle in AI Crawl Control — the single biggest lever in this audit.

This month

Needs writing, structured data, or outreach.

Publish a CPCM vs. NCMA's CPCM clarification page

+6 pts

Closes the one real gap in this test — AI currently answers this exact question with an unrelated organization entirely.

Add Organization + credential schema, linking James

+5 pts

Turns the thin, single-source mentions into full, linked citations.

Publish answer-first pages for the Bentonville/NW Arkansas and budget-conscious openings

+6 pts

Two real, already-surfaced gaps from the Opportunity Finder scan — one your own pricing already wins.

PILLAR-BY-PILLAR BREAKDOWN

Finding: Cloudflare edge block: GPTBot, ClaudeBot, CCBot, Bytespider, and Amazonbot all return HTTP 403. Only PerplexityBot and Google-Extended get through.

Fix: Unblock AI crawlers in Cloudflare (AI Crawl Control → allow GPTBot/ClaudeBot/CCBot) — one toggle, the single biggest lever in this audit.

ENTITY & SCHEMA · 8/20

CRITICAL

Finding: WordPress + Yoast with one generic JSON-LD block. Real org, team, and James's bio page exist, but no linked Person↔Organization graph, no rich sameAs.

Fix: Add Organization + credential (Certification/Course) schema; link key people including James.

CONTENT CITABILITY · 11/20

MODERATE

Finding: Genuine editorial content: certification overview, our-story, team, blog. Not answer-first, no FAQ schema.

Fix: Publish answer-first pages on “what is CPCA/CPCM/CPSA” and “how to get certified” — direct competitors to the training vendors.

OFF-SITE CORROBORATION · 16/20

MODERATE

Finding: Strong and established since 2004: CMA/SIMA history, conferences, certification body, LinkedIn, ZoomInfo, Datanyze.

Fix: Already solid — link these existing profiles into the new schema.

TECHNICAL FOUNDATION · 12/20

MODERATE

Finding: WordPress + Yoast + Cloudflare; sitemap_index present; indexed; healthy apart from the AI crawler block.

Fix: Minor cleanup once the Cloudflare block is resolved.

Want us to run these fixes for you?

Most of this can be done in a single session with the right system. Book a free 15-minute strategy call:
specularisinc.com/contact

— Adev Aarons, Founder, Specularis

Generated by the Specularis GEO Audit system from a live, real citation-finder run against ChatGPT, Claude, Perplexity, and Gemini on 2026-09-14.